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TOMORROW'S CHILD



**Screen Time &
Young Minds**

**Making Montessori
Work at Home**

**The Wonderful
World of Trees —
From Classrooms
to Canopies**





TOMORROW'S CHILD

The International Magazine for Montessori Families

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“Because when children believe they can change the world — they usually do.”

THE WONDERFUL WORLD OF TREES, PG. 25





Growing Up MONTESSORI

What to Expect Year by Year

by Jennifer Chen

Watching my son Jack transition from a wobbly 15-month-old to a confident six-year-old reader has been one of the most incredible journeys of my parenting life. When people ask me about Montessori, I always tell them: It's not just about the materials or the mixed-age classrooms—it's about witnessing your child unfold naturally, at their own perfect pace.

If you're wondering what this journey looks like year by year, here's what I've learned from watching Jack and his classmates grow up Montessori.

The Toddler Years (15 Months to 3 Years): Building the Foundation

Those First Steps Into Independence (15-18 months)

Remember how overwhelming it felt dropping off your baby for the first time? Jack clung to me like a koala for the



first week. But his guide, Ms. Anna, was incredibly patient, helping him feel safe while he watched the older toddlers confidently carrying their little trays and wiping up spills.

During these early months, you'll see your child:

- Slowly warming up to new routines (yes, there will be tears—yours and theirs!).

- Becoming fascinated with "real work" like spooning beans or carrying water.
- Starting to use words for everything they see and touch.
- Developing those crucial walking skills through all the purposeful movement.

I remember being amazed when Jack, at barely 18 months, insisted on carrying his own lunch tray to the table. At home, I was still carrying everything for him!

The "I Can Do It!" Phase (18-24 months)

This is when things get really exciting. Jack became obsessed with zippers, buttons, and anything that required fine-motor skills. He'd spend twenty minutes working on a single button, completely absorbed. At home, getting dressed took forever because he wanted to do everything himself.

During this phase, you'll notice:

- Your child's confidence soaring as they master new physical skills.
- An explosion of language—new words every single day.
- Growing interest in helping with real tasks (let them help with laundry).
- The beginnings of toilet awareness (but don't stress about timelines).

My friend Sarah laughed that her daughter Maya became the "snack monitor" at 20 months, carefully counting out crackers for her classmates.

The Social Butterfly Emerges (24-36 months)

By two-and-a-half, Jack was a completely different child. He'd bounce into school, chatting with friends and heading

straight to his favorite activities. The parallel play of earlier months transformed into genuine friendships.

This final toddler year brings:

- Real conversations and storytelling.
- Mastery of self-care routines (goodbye, diaper changes).
- Artistic expression through painting, clay, and creative play.
- Empathy and kindness toward younger children.
- Growing attention span and focus.

I'll never forget watching Jack comfort a crying friend by bringing him a tissue and sitting quietly beside him. That kind of emotional intelligence develops naturally in this environment.

The Primary Years (Ages 3-6): Where the Magic Happens

Year One: The Wide-Eyed Explorer (Ages 3-4)

Starting Primary felt like entering a magical world. Jack was mesmerized by the older children's confidence and the beautiful materials beckoning from every shelf. Those first months were all about exploration and finding his place in this new community.

During this year, you'll see:

- Your child gravitate toward hands-on activities (Jack loved the Pink Tower).
- Beginning to trace letters and recognize sounds.
- Counting and beginning to understand numbers through concrete materials.

- Learning about the world through puzzle maps and nature studies.
- Developing grace and courtesy through daily interactions.

The Practical Life work was still Jack's favorite—he'd spend ages polishing silver or arranging flowers, building the concentration and coordination he'd need for later academic work.

Year Two: The Confident Learner (Ages 4-5)

This is when academic learning really takes off, but in the most natural way. Jack started building words with the Moveable Alphabet before he could even write letters. He was reading simple words by Christmas and writing stories by spring.

- Year two typically brings:
- Deeper engagement with all subject areas.
- Beginning reading and writing. (at their own pace!).
- Understanding place value through the famous golden beads.
- Exploring science through hands-on experiments.
- Taking on more responsibility in the classroom community.

I remember Jack's excitement when he finally mastered the Binomial Cube—a complex three-dimensional puzzle that prepares children for algebra concepts. He was so proud to show me how all the pieces fit together.

Year Three: The Classroom Leader (Ages 5-6)

If you're debating whether to keep your child for the third year, let me tell you: This is when everything comes

together. Jack transformed from a student into a teacher, helping younger children and taking genuine ownership of his learning.

The third year is magical because children:

- Read fluently and write with confidence.
- Understand complex math concepts and can explain them to others.



- Lead classroom discussions and help solve conflicts.
- Mentor younger children with patience and kindness.
- Develop genuine academic confidence and love of learning.

Watching Jack teach a three-year-old how to pour water or help a friend sound out a word showed me that he hadn't just learned facts—he'd learned how to learn and how to care for others.

A Typical Day: What Your Child Actually Experiences

The three-hour morning work period is the heart of the Montessori day. Children choose their own activities based on interest and readiness, working alone or with friends. Jack might start with math work, move to reading, then spend time on a geography project—all self-directed.

The day flows naturally:

- ◆ Morning greeting and settling into work.
- ◆ Individual lessons with the guide.



- ◆ Snack when hungry (not when the clock says it's time).
- ◆ Outdoor exploration and movement
- ◆ Group time for stories, songs, and cultural lessons.
- ◆ Lunch and rest time.

What I love most is that children aren't rushed from activity to activity. They have time to deeply engage with materials and ideas.

The Beautiful Mixed-Age Magic

One of the most remarkable aspects of Jack's Montessori experience has been watching him grow within the same classroom community. As a three-year-old, he looked up to the six-year-olds with awe. By his third year, he was the one being looked up to.

This progression creates:

- ◆ Natural mentoring relationships.
- ◆ Genuine leadership opportunities.

- ◆ Reduced academic pressure (no single "grade level" to meet).
- ◆ Lasting friendships across age groups.
- ◆ A true sense of classroom community.

Supporting the Journey at Home

The best thing you can do is trust the process and support your child's growing independence. We set up low shelves with Jack's art supplies, let him help with real household tasks, and read together every single day.

Most importantly, we learned to step back and let Jack struggle through challenges. The patience and problem-solving skills he developed in school transferred beautifully to home life.

The Transformation

Looking back at photos from Jack's first day at 15 months and his Primary graduation at six, I'm amazed by the transformation. He went from a toddler who needed help with everything to a confident, capable child who approaches new challenges with curiosity instead of fear.

But the real magic isn't just in what he learned—it's in who he became. He's kind, thoughtful, and genuinely excited about learning. He can focus deeply on tasks that interest him, work collaboratively with others, and approach problems with confidence.

That's the gift of growing up Montessori: not just academic preparation, but the development of a whole human being who's ready to take on the world with confidence, compassion, and joy. ■



Jennifer Chen is a Montessori educator and proud parent.



LUNCH BOXES & Learning

Building Independence Through Daily Routines

by Montessori Foundation Staff

In Montessori education, every experience—no matter how small—is an opportunity to build independence, responsibility, and confidence. That includes the daily tasks we might otherwise rush through, like getting dressed, preparing a lunchbox, or packing a backpack.

At first glance, these routines might seem trivial compared to academic lessons. But in Montessori, they are seen as essential parts of a child's development. When children are encouraged to take ownership of these everyday responsibilities, they gain more than just practical skills—they develop habits of self-reliance that shape how they approach learning, relationships, and life itself.

The Power of Practical Life

Montessori classrooms include an entire area dedicated to Practical Life activities, such as pouring, cutting, cleaning, and food preparation. These activities help children develop:

- **Coordination:** Fine-motor skills that support writing and other academic tasks.
- **Order and Sequencing:** Understanding steps in a process—from washing hands before a meal to organizing materials for a project.
- **Concentration:** The ability to focus deeply on purposeful tasks.
- **Independence:** A growing sense of “I can do it myself!” that spills over into all areas of life.

When children practice these skills at home—through dressing themselves, packing their lunch, or helping with meal prep—they reinforce the same capacities nurtured in the classroom.



Packing the Lunchbox: A Lesson in Choice and Responsibility

Instead of quickly packing your child's lunch for them, consider inviting your child to help—or even take the lead. For younger children, this might mean choosing from a set of options you provide (Would you like apple slices or grapes today?). Older children can help assemble sandwiches, portion snacks, and even plan the menu for the week.

Through packing their own lunch, children learn:

- **Planning:** Deciding what to include requires thinking ahead.
- **Nutrition:** They start to understand what makes a balanced meal.

- **Self-Care:** Choosing foods they enjoy encourages mindfulness about what nourishes their bodies.
- **Pride in Preparation:** When a child eats a lunch they helped prepare, it often tastes better simply because they had a hand in making it.



Dressing for Success: More Than Just Clothes

Getting dressed might seem like a small task, but for a child, it's a big step toward autonomy. Montessori teachers encourage children to dress themselves from an early age, using clothing that's easy to manage, like elastic waistbands, large buttons, and simple fasteners.

At home, giving your child time to dress themselves each morning sends a powerful message: I believe in your ability to care for yourself.

This simple routine helps children develop:

- Fine-motor skills (zipping, buttoning, tying),
- Decision-making skills (choosing weather-appropriate clothing),
- Time awareness (getting ready within a timeframe),
- Confidence and competence.

It may take longer at first—and it can be tempting to jump in when the clock is ticking—but that extra time is an investment in your child's growing self-sufficiency.

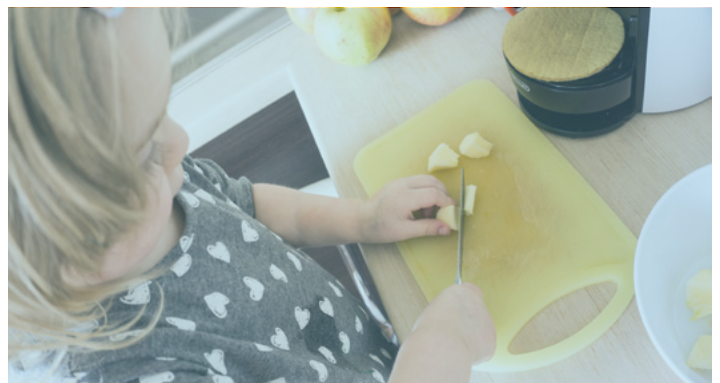
Building a little bit of extra time into the activity decreases tension on both sides.

Small Tasks, Big Life Skills

Each of these daily routines—dressing, packing lunch, getting out the door on time—builds layers of important life skills:

- **Sequencing:** Understanding the order in which things need to happen.
- **Personal Responsibility:** Knowing they are capable of managing their own needs.
- **Problem-Solving:** Figuring out how to open tricky lunch containers or adapt to a forgotten item.
- **Self-Confidence:** Feeling proud of their ability to care for themselves.

And perhaps most importantly, these routines build executive function—the mental skills that help us plan, focus attention, remember instructions, and juggle multiple tasks. These are critical for success not only in school but throughout life.



How Parents Can Support Independence at Home

- **Create a Child-Friendly Setup:** Use low hooks, step stools, and accessible shelves so your child can reach their clothes, lunch supplies, and backpack.

3-6 Years | A New Level of Independence

- **Allow Time:** Start the morning a bit earlier to give your child time to complete tasks without rushing.
- **Offer Choices:** Guide your child by offering limited, appropriate choices (e.g., “Would you like the blue shirt or the red one?”).
- **Be Patient:** Mastery takes time and repetition. Focus on progress, not perfection.
- **Model and Teach:** Show your child how to do a task, then step back and let them try.

Independence: A Gift That Lasts

When we slow down and invite children to participate in daily routines, we’re not just saving a few minutes for ourselves—we’re empowering them for life. These small, everyday tasks build the mindset and abilities that help

Montessori children become capable, thoughtful, and self-directed learners.

So the next time your child zips up their jacket or carefully places their sandwich in their lunchbox, know that they’re not just getting ready for the day—they’re preparing for life. ■



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Understanding the Three-Year Cycle in Montessori

Why Multi-Age Classrooms Work

by Maria Rodriguez



After more than twenty years as a Montessori guide, I've witnessed countless *aha* moments when parents finally understand why we structure our classrooms the way we do. Just last week, a parent asked me, "Why is my five-year-old in the same room as three-year-olds? Shouldn't she be with kids her own age?"

It's a fair question and one I love answering, because the three-year cycle is truly the heart of what makes Montessori education so powerful.

In my primary classroom, I watch the same children grow from tentative three-year-olds to confident six-year-olds who practically run the place. It's not just about mixing ages; it's about creating a living, breathing community, where each child has a role that evolves over time.

Take Maya, for example. When she first arrived as a shy three-year-old, she spent weeks observing before she even touched a material. Now, in her third year, she's the one who notices when a new child needs help finding the bathroom or shows them how to roll a work mat properly. That

“There’s something about the way a child explains a concept that resonates with another child’s understanding.”

transformation doesn’t happen overnight; it unfolds over three years of building trust, competence, and confidence.

I see this pattern repeat with every child:

- » First-year children (ages 3-4) are like sponges, absorbing everything around them. They’re learning not just academic skills, but how to be part of a community. They watch the older children with wide eyes, unconsciously learning social graces and work habits.
- » Second-year children (ages 4-5) find their stride. They know the routines, they’ve built relationships, and they’re ready to tackle more complex work. They start helping younger children naturally, not because I ask them to, but because they want to.
- » Third-year children (ages 5-6) become the classroom leaders. They’ve internalized the peace table process, enabling them to resolve conflicts effectively, and they take genuine pride in mentoring younger friends. This is their capstone year, when everything they’ve learned comes together in remarkable ways.

Why This Structure Works So Well

The Gift of Time and Continuity: One of the most beautiful aspects of the three-year cycle is that I get to truly know each child. I observe their learning patterns, their interests, their challenges, and their growth spurts. By the third year, I know that Marcus learns best in the morning, that Sophia needs extra time to process new concepts, and that Ahmed is ready for advanced math work even though he’s only five.

This deep knowledge allows me to meet each child exactly where they are, not where a curriculum guide says they should be.

Learning without Artificial Limits: In traditional classrooms, children are often held back by grade-level expectations. In my Montessori environment, I’ve seen four-year-olds reading chapter books and six-year-olds just beginning to write their names; both scenarios are perfectly normal and celebrated.

Last year, I had a five-year-old who was fascinated by the decimal system. Instead of saying “that’s too advanced,” I introduced him to more complex math materials. Meanwhile, his age-mate was still perfecting her Practical Life skills, and that was exactly what she needed.

The Magic of Peer Teaching: Some of my most powerful teaching moments happen when I step back and let the children teach each other. When six-year-old Elena explains the Color Tablets to three-year-old Jordan, she’s not just being helpful; she’s reinforcing her understanding in a way that no worksheet ever could.

I’ve noticed that children often learn better from their peers than from adults. There’s something about the way a child explains a concept that resonates with another child’s understanding.



Building Real Leadership Skills: By their third year, children in my classroom aren’t just older; they’re genuinely responsible community members. They help resolve conflicts, they notice when someone needs support, and they take ownership of our classroom environment.

I remember watching six-year-old David comfort a crying three-year-old by getting him a tissue and sitting quietly beside him until he felt better. That kind of emotional intelligence and empathy develops through years of being part of a caring community.



When the Cycle Gets Interrupted

It breaks my heart a little when families leave before completing the three-year cycle. The third year is when children shine—when they get to be the “big kids” who have waited patiently for their turn to lead.

I’ve seen children who left after two years and came back to visit. They’re often wistful, saying things like, “I wish I could have been a helper like Sarah is now.” They sense they missed something important.

That said, children who join mid-cycle can still benefit enormously. They just need extra support to find their place in our established community.

What I Tell Parents

When parents worry about the multi-age classroom, I remind them that this is how learning happens in real life. In families, older siblings naturally help younger ones. In communities, people of all ages work together. Our classroom simply mirrors this natural dynamic.

I also encourage parents to trust the process, especially during those quieter developmental periods. Some years,

your child might seem to plateau academically while they’re doing important social and emotional work. Other years, they’ll make dramatic leaps. Both are valuable and necessary.

If I could convince every parent of just one thing, it would be to stay for that crucial third year. This is when children experience what we call academic explosion, when reading, writing, and math concepts suddenly click in profound ways.

But more than that, it’s when children develop true confidence. They’ve mastered the environment, they know their place in the community, and they’re ready to take on bigger challenges. They leave my classroom not just academically prepared but emotionally and socially ready for whatever comes next.

My classroom is a living laboratory, where children discover not just academic concepts but how to be human beings in community with others. The three-year cycle gives them the time and space to develop at their own pace while contributing to something larger than themselves.

After all these years, I still get excited watching a timid three-year-old transform into a confident six-year-old leader. It’s a privilege to witness this growth, and it’s only possible because we honor the natural rhythm of child development through our three-year cycle.

The mixed-age classroom isn’t just a nice idea; it’s a carefully designed environment that allows children to experience themselves as learners, helpers, and leaders. And that, ultimately, is what prepares them not just for the next level of school, but for life itself. ■



Maria Rodriguez is a Montessori guide. She holds her Primary Montessori certification and is passionate about helping parents understand the beauty of Montessori education.

SCREEN TIME & YOUNG MINDS

Recommendations for Technology Use at Home— The Montessori Way

by Tim Seldin, President, The Montessori Foundation



In today's world, screens are everywhere—smartphones, tablets, televisions, laptops—filling our homes, workplaces, and even classrooms. For parents trying to raise children in alignment with Montessori principles, navigating this reality can feel overwhelming. How much screen time is too much? Is any screen time appropriate for young children? And most importantly, what would Maria Montessori think about the role of technology in a child's development?

While Dr. Montessori lived long before the digital age, her observations about child development remain remarkably relevant. If she were with us today, I believe she would encourage us to ask: *Does this technology serve the child's development? Does it help them grow in independence, curiosity, confidence, and self-awareness?* With those questions in mind, let's explore what Montessori suggests about technology use at home.

The Montessori Perspective: Hands Before Screens

At the heart of Montessori education is the understanding that young children (especially those under six) learn best through direct, hands-on engagement with the real world. Movement, the manipulation of physical materials, and rich sensory experiences are essential for brain development in these formative years.

By contrast, screens offer a two-dimensional experience that tends to be passive. Whether it's a video, a digital game, or even an educational app, the experience often lacks the tactile feedback, movement, and deep concentration that Montessori materials provide. That's why we suggest that for infants, toddlers, and very young children, screen time should be minimal or avoided entirely in favor of real-life experiences.

Dr. Montessori described the “absorbent mind” as the young child's extraordinary ability to learn simply by interacting with their environment. To flourish, this absorbent mind needs real things: to touch, taste, climb, build, carry, pour, and explore—not just to swipe, tap, or watch.

Why Real-World Engagement Matters

The first years of life are when children build foundational skills: understanding cause and effect; developing spatial awareness; mastering language; and learning how to interact socially. These developmental tasks are best supported by:

- Handling real objects (blocks, utensils, tools);
- Moving freely and with purpose (indoors and outdoors);
- Conversing with real people in their daily lives;

- Exploring nature: digging in the dirt, observing insects, feeling the wind; and
- Participating in practical life activities, such as cooking, cleaning, gardening.
- Time spent in front of screens can displace these crucial, real-world experiences. While some digital content may be educational in intention, it still can't replace the development of fine-motor skills, emotional intelligence, and problem-solving abilities that come from active, hands-on learning.

What About Older Children?

As children grow, particularly after age six, their cognitive abilities mature, and they become more capable of abstract thinking and symbolic reasoning. At this stage, Montessori principles still prioritize concrete experiences, but technology can start to play a thoughtful, purposeful role in learning.

Older children might:

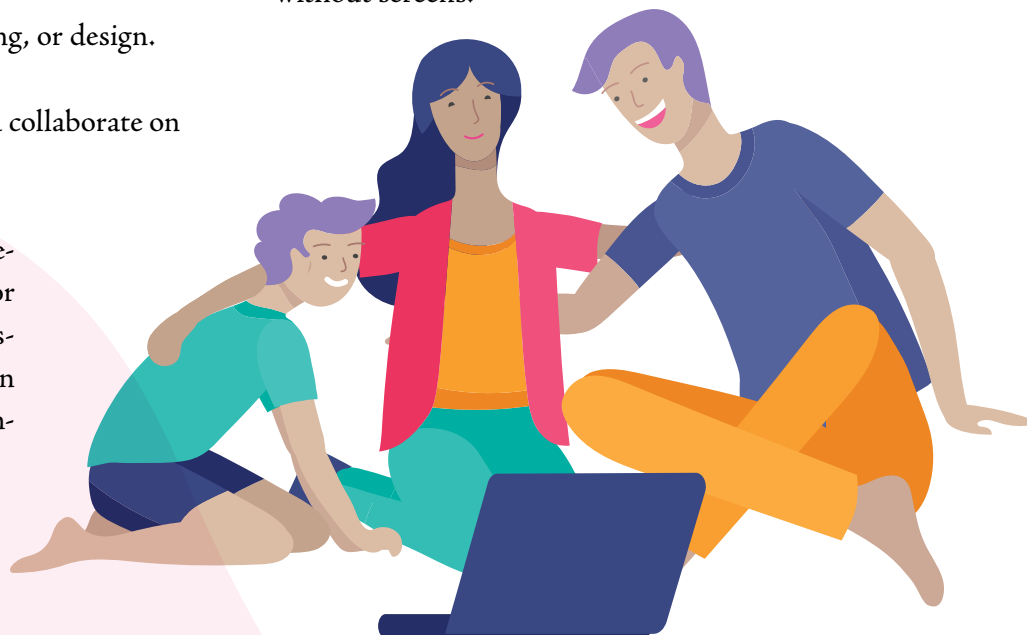
- Research topics that capture their curiosity.
- Create presentations, stories, or digital artwork.
- Use apps for music composition, coding, or design.
- Communicate with distant family and collaborate on group projects.

Even then, the Montessori guideline remains: Technology should be a tool for creation, inquiry, and connection, not passive consumption. The goal is for children to be producers of knowledge, not just consumers of entertainment.

Guiding Principles for Montessori Families on Technology

If you want to align your family's technology use with Montessori principles, here are the core guidelines I recommend.

- **Delay Introduction for Young Children:** For those under the age of three, avoid screens entirely, except for the occasional family video call.
- **Prioritize Hands-On Learning:** Make sure each day includes unstructured play, movement, outdoor exploration, and practical tasks.
- **Be Intentional:** Select high-quality, developmentally appropriate content that encourages critical thinking or creativity. Avoid content that is loud, fast-paced, or reward-driven.
- **Watch Together:** When screens are used, join your child. Co-viewing makes the experience social, gives you the opportunity to ask questions, and deepens understanding.
- **Model Balanced Behavior:** Children learn from our example. Let them see you read, cook, create, and engage without screens.





“The key is balance, intentionality, and keeping the child’s development at the center of every decision.”

- **Set Consistent Limits:** Establish clear boundaries around screen time, such as avoiding devices during meals, before bedtime, or in bedrooms.
- **Encourage Creation Over Consumption:** Opt for screen activities that let children create—whether that’s drawing, coding, making videos, or creating music.

guiding them to engage with it wisely, with curiosity, and with joy. ■

A Montessori Vision for Technology

If Maria Montessori were alive today, I believe she’d remind us that technology is neither inherently good nor bad; it’s a tool. The question is always: *How does this serve the child’s growth?*

For young minds, there is no substitute for real experiences. But for older children, technology (used thoughtfully) can extend their ability to explore, create, and connect with the world. The key is balance, intentionality, and keeping the child’s development at the center of every decision.

In Montessori, our work is always to support the child’s unfolding—not by shielding them from the world, but by



Tim Seldin is President of the Montessori Foundation. His more than 40 years of experience in Montessori education includes 22 years as Headmaster of the Barrie School in Silver Spring, Maryland, his *alma mater* from toddler through high school graduation. Tim was Co-Founder and Director of the Institute for Advanced Montessori Studies and the Center for Guided Montessori Studies. He earned a B.A. in History and Philosophy from Georgetown University, an M.Ed. in Educational Administration and Supervision from The American University, and his Montessori certification from the American Montessori Society.

Tim is the author of several books on Montessori Education, including *How to Raise An Amazing Child*, and *The World in the Palm of Her Hand*. Look for his newest book, *Montessori for Every Family*, co-authored with Lorna McGrath.

OUR MONTESSORI FAMILY SCREEN-TIME AGREEMENT

To help families navigate these decisions together, here is a Montessori Family Screen-Time Agreement you can adapt to your own needs. This is a living document. Just like children, our family's needs and rhythms will grow and change. Revisit the agreement together as your children mature or as new tools and technologies emerge.

OUR FAMILY PRINCIPLES FOR SCREEN USE

- We use screens to create, learn, or connect, not just to pass time.
- Screen time never replaces outdoor play, creative projects, reading, family time, or movement.
- We protect our minds and bodies by taking regular breaks from screens.
- We discuss what we see, play, or watch, asking questions and sharing thoughts.
- We model respectful and balanced screen use.

CHECKING IN

Once a week, we'll talk as a family about:

- What we've enjoyed or learned.
- Whether we feel balanced.
- Any changes we'd like to make.

RESPONSIBILITY

- Everyone in the family takes responsibility for following these agreements.
- If it's hard to follow the plan, we'll talk about it and problem solve together.

FAMILY AGREEMENTS

When We Use Screens

- Screens are used between: _____
- Screens are not used during meals, family time, or before bed.
- Non-screen activities come first: play, reading, chores, creativity.

Where We Use Screens

- Screens are used in: _____
(common areas like the living room).
- Screens are not used in bedrooms.

Reasons We Use Screens

- Learning and research.
- Creative activities (art, music, coding).
- Video calls with family and friends.
- Educational documentaries or shows chosen together.

We avoid:

- Content that is violent, disrespectful, or too loud and fast-paced.
- Games that reward constant attention or excessive competition.

Time Limits

- Weekday screen time: _____ minutes per day
- Weekend/holiday screen time: _____ minutes per day
- Time after screens is for quiet, movement, or outdoor play.

Parent(s)/Caregiver(s) Signature

Date:

Child(ren) Signature

Date:

What's New in Montessori?

by Montessori Foundation Staff

Innovations & Timeless Traditions for 2025-2026

Every September brings a familiar energy to Montessori classrooms: new faces, new lessons, and new opportunities to explore the world. As the 2025-2026 school year begins, parents may wonder—what's changing in Montessori education? The beauty of Montessori is its foundation of timeless principles, yet it also evolves to meet the needs of today's children and families.

Here's a look at what's fresh and what remains steadfast in Montessori classrooms this year.

Timeless Traditions That Still Shine

At its core, Montessori remains true to the vision Maria Montessori shared over a century ago: an education designed to cultivate independence, concentration, respect, and a lifelong love of learning. Some things never change—and for good reason.

- **The Prepared Environment:** Classrooms are still meticulously organized, inviting, and scaled to the child's size and perspective. This empowers children to navigate their space independently.
- **The Three-Year Cycle:** Multi-age classrooms continue to foster

mentorship, leadership, and deep, individualized learning. Children progress at their own pace within a community that mirrors family life.

- **Hands-On, Self-Correcting Materials:** Montessori materials remain the gold standard for concrete, tactile learning. Whether it's the Pink Tower in early childhood or Algebra Tiles in the upper levels, these tools translate abstract concepts into something a child can touch and explore.
- **Grace and Courtesy:** The social fabric of the classroom remains intentional. Children are still guided in respectful communication, empathy, and collaboration—skills as essential in life as reading or math.



Emerging Patterns

While the foundation remains strong, Montessori schools today are thoughtfully integrating new insights, tools, and strategies to keep the experience relevant and supportive.



- **Mindfulness and Well-Being Programs:** Many Montessori schools are now embedding mindfulness practices into the daily routine—guided breathing, yoga stretches, or quiet reflection times help children develop emotional regulation in a fast-paced world.
- **Enhanced Outdoor Classrooms:** Outdoor learning spaces have expanded well beyond playgrounds. Schools are incorporating nature-based classrooms, gardening, and environmental stewardship activities that extend the Montessori curriculum into the natural world.
- **Contemporary Cultural Studies:** Montessori's focus on geography, history, and culture now includes current global challenges. Topics like climate change, sustainability, and global citizenship are becoming integrated in ways that are age-appropriate and action-oriented. Typically, there is no political agenda. Montessori families

represent a wide range of traditions and perspectives. The common theme is to honor the country in which we live, while learning about and celebrating the many cultures and traditions of the people who came to our country from the global community.

- **Montessori and Technology—With Care:** While Montessori remains cautious about screens for young children, thoughtfully curated digital tools are increasingly used with older students. Tools like digital microscopes, coding platforms, and collaborative research software enhance exploration in science and humanities without replacing hands-on learning.
- **Inclusion:** Many Montessori schools are deepening their commitment to inclusive education. This includes diversifying classroom materials and literature, celebrating a broader range of cultural traditions, and fostering conversations about equity, belonging, and respect.

The Montessori Continuum: Stronger Than Ever

Another exciting development is the growth of Montessori education beyond early childhood. More schools are offering Montessori programs for elementary, middle, and even high school students, giving families the option to continue this philosophy through adolescence. These programs incorporate more complex projects, entrepreneurship, and real-world experiences—all still grounded in Montessori's developmental approach.



A Living Tradition

Montessori is often described as both an art and a science of education. Its enduring strength lies in the balance between preserving proven methods and embracing innovations that serve today's learners. As you send your child off to school this fall, you can be confident that they are part of a living tradition—one that honors the child's natural development while preparing them for the world they will inherit.

2025 Montessori-Inspired Trends for Parents

Montessori education doesn't stop at the classroom door. Many parents want to bring elements of the Montessori approach into their homes, and new ideas are making it easier than ever. Here's what's trending with Montessori families this year:

- **Home Organization for Independence:** Parents are rethinking home spaces to help children do more for

themselves—think low shelves, accessible kitchen tools, and self-serve snack stations. New modular furniture systems designed for Montessori homes are also gaining popularity.

- **Mindful Tech Use:** Families are adopting digital wellness practices—setting boundaries around screen time and using tech-free times for family connection. Some are introducing “tech sabbath” days on weekends to rest from screens altogether.
- **Nature Play and Outdoor Learning:** With the growth of outdoor classrooms, parents are creating home gardens, nature play areas, and even simple outdoor art spaces to encourage exploration and physical activity.
- **Diverse Bookshelves:** Parents are expanding their home libraries with children's books that celebrate diverse cultures, perspectives, and stories—mirroring the inclusion that we tend to see in schools.
- **Montessori Parenting Courses:** A growing number of online courses and parent education groups help families learn how to apply Montessori principles in daily parenting, including positive discipline, fostering independence, and nurturing curiosity at home.

By embracing some of these trends, families can extend the benefits of Montessori education and help their children thrive in every environment. ■

MAKING MONTESSORI WORK *at Home*

Creating Simple Spaces for Growth

by Montessori Foundation Staff

A young child with light brown hair, wearing a yellow knit sweater, is focused on playing with a wooden Montessori-style toy. The toy consists of several thick wooden rods of different colors (yellow, red, blue, green) arranged in a geometric pattern. In the background, a green wooden ladder-like structure is visible, and a whiteboard with red markings is partially seen. The scene is set indoors with soft, natural lighting.

When visitors step into a Montessori classroom for the first time, they're often struck by its beauty, calm, and sense of order. The environment feels inviting, child-centered, and purposeful. Children move confidently, choosing their work, returning materials neatly to their places, and engaging with others in peaceful collaboration.

Naturally, many parents wonder: *How can we bring some of that magic into our home?*

Fortunately, you don't need to replicate a Montessori classroom to make Montessori work at home. By creating simple, intentional spaces that foster independence and choice within clear boundaries, you can nurture your child's growth in confidence, curiosity, and responsibility right where you live.

The Prepared Home: More Than Furniture

In Montessori, the environment is considered the “third teacher,” alongside the adult and the materials. But creating a Montessori-inspired home is not about buying specialized furniture or expensive educational tools. Instead, it’s about preparing your home in ways that align with how children naturally learn and develop.

At its heart, a Montessori-inspired home environment:

- Encourages independence and self-care.
- Respects your child’s pace of learning and natural interests.
- Builds a sense of order and predictability.
- Promotes collaboration and peaceful interactions.

These qualities can be cultivated in any home, regardless of size, style, or budget.

Start Small: Setting Up Spaces for Independence

Rather than overhauling your entire home, begin by preparing just one space where your child can act independently, make choices, and contribute to family life.

The Entryway:

Make arrivals and departures easier by setting up a small bench where your child can sit to put on shoes. Add low hooks for coats and backpacks, and a basket for shoes or hats. When a child can manage their own belongings, it fosters a sense of personal responsibility.

The Kitchen:

Invite your child to participate in preparing food by providing access to a low shelf, stocked with their own utensils, cups, and plates. A child-sized water dispenser or pitcher

allows them to pour their own drinks. Keep simple snacks within reach, empowering them to serve themselves. A learning tower or sturdy stool lets them safely help with washing vegetables, stirring, or baking.

The Bathroom:

With a low stool, your child can reach the sink to brush their teeth or wash their hands. Store towels, washcloths, and grooming items at their level to encourage independent self-care.

The Bedroom:

Create a calm, uncluttered space where your child can dress themselves. An open wardrobe or a low shelf with limited clothing options lets them make decisions without feeling overwhelmed. A small bookshelf with a curated selection of books fosters a love of reading.

Living & Learning Spaces:

Provide low shelves with a few open-ended toys, puzzles, and art materials. Organize these items so each has its place. Fewer choices displayed at a time help children focus deeply and complete activities before moving on to the next.

The Power of Simplicity and Order

Children thrive in environments where there is order and clarity. In a Montessori home, this means everything has a place, and children are involved in maintaining that order. Instead of being told to “clean up your room,” children are shown where things go, why it’s important, and are given the time to do it themselves.

This predictability helps children build not only Practical Life skills but also internal discipline and a sense of accomplishment.

“A Montessori home nurtures a child’s innate desire to contribute, to learn, and to grow—not because they are forced but because they feel respected, capable, and connected.”

Using Real, Purposeful Tools

Montessori encourages using real tools rather than toy imitations. Children can learn to care for their home with child-sized but functional tools—small brooms, dustpans, kitchen utensils, and gardening tools. Using real tools teaches them that their contributions are meaningful and valued.

Freedom Within Limits

A Montessori home is not a free-for-all; it is structured to provide freedom within clear, consistent boundaries. Children can make choices, but those choices are framed by safety, respect, and shared family values. For example, children might choose their own clothing from a set of weather-appropriate options, or decide which snack to eat from a selection you’ve prepared.

Observe and Adapt

As your child grows, their needs and interests will change. The Montessori approach emphasizes careful observation—watching how your child uses a space or material and making adjustments accordingly. If a shelf is being emptied but nothing is being engaged with, it might be time to rotate the materials or simplify the choices.

Creating a Calm Atmosphere

Montessori classrooms feel peaceful because they are designed to minimize chaos and overstimulation. At home, this might mean reducing clutter, using natural materials, and keeping decor calm, rather than bright and busy. Soft lighting, neutral tones, and quiet background music can contribute to an atmosphere of focus and peace.

Making Montessori a Way of Life

Setting up Montessori-inspired spaces is just the beginning. The deeper work is in creating a home culture based on respect, collaboration, and curiosity. This means:

- Speaking to your child with kindness and patience.
- Involving them in everyday life—cooking, cleaning, gardening.
- Encouraging effort rather than praising outcomes.
- Allowing mistakes as opportunities to learn.
- Holding family meetings where even young children have a voice.

Over time, these practices build not just a home that is tidy and organized, but a family culture that is cooperative, respectful, and joyful.

The Real Reward

When children are trusted with real responsibilities, they rise to the occasion. A Montessori home nurtures a child’s innate desire to contribute, to learn, and to grow—not because they are forced but because they feel respected, capable, and connected.

In the end, preparing the environment is really about preparing the child for life, and preparing ourselves, as parents, to see and support their remarkable potential. ■



Montessori-Inspired Home Room-by-Room Checklist

Simple Ways to Foster Independence, Order, and Confidence.

Entryway / Mudroom

- ☐ Low hooks for coats, hats, and bags
- ☐ Small bench or chair for putting on/taking off shoes
- ☐ Basket or shelf for shoes
- ☐ Mirror at child's height for last checks before heading out
- ☐ Seasonal accessories (like mittens or sunglasses) stored where the child can reach

Kitchen

- ☐ Child-sized dishes, cups, and utensils on a low shelf
- ☐ Low shelf or accessible bin for healthy snacks
- ☐ Small water dispenser or pitcher with cups
- ☐ Learning tower or step stool for safe access to counters
- ☐ Child-sized tools: vegetable peeler, spreading knife, small cutting board
- ☐ Cleaning tools: small broom, dustpan, cloth for spills
- ☐ Space for the child to help set the table or prepare simple meals

Bathroom

- ☐ Step stool to reach the sink
- ☐ Low hook for towel and washcloth
- ☐ Toothbrush, toothpaste, and grooming items organized in a reachable spot
- ☐ Mirror at child's height or an adjustable one
- ☐ Laundry basket accessible for putting dirty clothes away
- ☐ Toilet learning accessories if needed: small potty or seat insert

Living Room / Play Space

- ☐ Low shelves with curated toys, puzzles, and materials displayed neatly
- ☐ Toys organized in baskets or trays for easy access and return
- ☐ Open floor space for movement and play
- ☐ A cozy reading corner with a small chair or floor cushion
- ☐ Art materials (like crayons, paper, and scissors) in a contained, accessible spot
- ☐ Natural, calming colors and lighting to reduce overstimulation

Dining Area

- ☐ Child-sized chair or booster seat at the family table
- ☐ Cloth napkins, placemats, and utensils within reach for setting their own place
- ☐ Water jug or pitcher at the table so the child can pour their own drink
- ☐ Predictable mealtime routine that includes family-style serving when possible

Bedroom

- ☐ Floor bed or low bed to allow getting in and out independently
- ☐ Low wardrobe, dresser, or open shelving with a limited selection of clothing
- ☐ Hamper for dirty clothes
- ☐ Low bookshelf with a small, rotating selection of books
- ☐ A calm, uncluttered space for dressing and quiet activities
- ☐ Nightlight or accessible light switch for independence at bedtime

Laundry & Cleaning

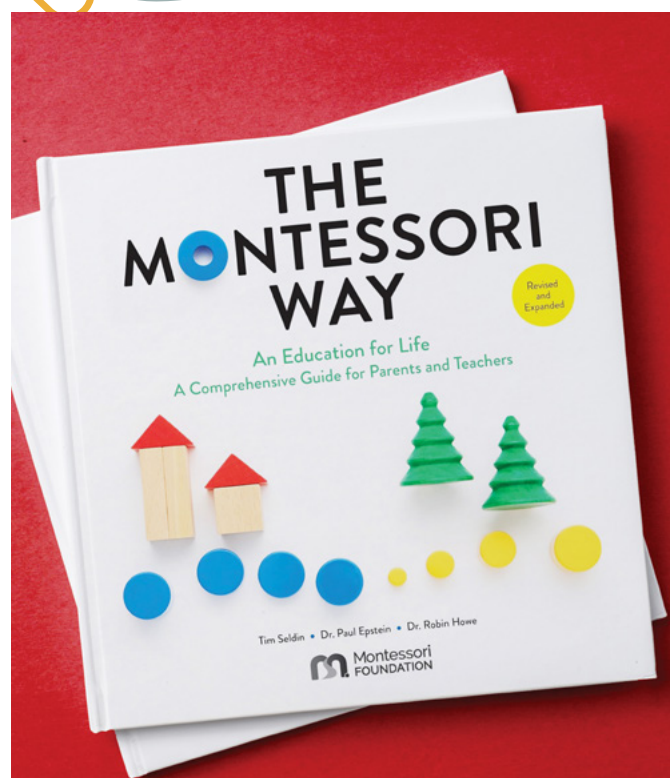
- ☐ Small laundry basket for the child to carry clothes to the washer
- ☐ Small spray bottle with water and a cloth for wiping surfaces
- ☐ Short-handled broom and dustpan
- ☐ Child-safe participation in sorting laundry, folding, and simple chores

Outdoors / Garden

- ☐ Child-sized gardening tools
- ☐ Easy-to-reach watering can
- ☐ Designated area for digging, planting, or exploring nature
- ☐ Outdoor toys organized in a reachable bin or shelf
- ☐ Space for gross-motor play: running, climbing, balancing

Bonus Tips

- ☐ Rotate toys and materials regularly to maintain interest without overwhelming.
- ☐ Label baskets or shelves with words or pictures to guide organization.
- ☐ Involve your child in setting up and maintaining these spaces to build ownership.



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Discover the transformative power of Montessori education with *The Montessori Way, Revised and Expanded*.

This book serves as an all-encompassing guide to understanding and implementing the Montessori Method in various settings. It starts with a strong emphasis on the core principles of Montessori, such as child-centered learning, independence, and hands-on experiences.

Offering expert advice from author and Montessori Foundation President Timothy Seldin's forty-plus years in Montessori education, this revised edition includes:

- **Comprehensive Coverage:** From the history of Montessori education to its modern-day applications, the book offers an in-depth look at this unique approach.
- **Practical Guidance:** Learn how to set up a Montessori-friendly environment at home or in the classroom, complete with tips on materials, activities, and routines.
- **Developmental Insights:** Gain a deeper understanding of how Montessori supports different stages of child development, including cognitive, social, and emotional growth.
- **Real-Life Examples:** Discover success stories and case studies that illustrate the positive impact of Montessori education on children.

THE WONDERFUL WORLD OF TREES

 upschool

From Classrooms to Canopies: Upschool's Mission to Help Schools Plant a Million Trees in 2025

A SEED PLANTED WITH PURPOSE

In a modest apartment in Sydney, Australia, surrounded by handwritten notes and books on education, Montessori teacher, Montessori Australia Ambassador, author, TEDx speaker, and co-founder of Upschool, Gavin McCormack, sat down with one goal: to create a course that would help children feel their power to change the world.

The result was *The Wonderful World of Trees* — a free, globally accessible education program designed to connect children with the natural world, empower them to take meaningful local action and, ultimately, help plant forests in countries across the planet through a partnership with global tree-planting initiative, *Evertreen*.

The concept was disarmingly simple: inspire children to learn about trees, care for one locally, and then make a real-world impact by planting a forest somewhere they may never visit, for people they may never meet.

THE URGENCY OF NOW

In a world facing climate breakdown, deforestation, and environmental collapse, *The Wonderful World of Trees* arrives as more than a learning module; it's a response.

According to the UN's Food and Agriculture Organization, the world loses approximately 10 million hectares of forest each year. That's the equivalent of 30 football fields per minute. As fires blaze, biodiversity shrinks, and weather systems shift, the next generation is growing up surrounded by environmental uncertainty.

This course doesn't sugar-coat the truth. Instead, it empowers children with knowledge, agency, and hope. They are not passive bystanders. They are active participants in healing the Earth.

TEACHING THROUGH ACTION

The Wonderful World of Trees is built on a simple truth: when children engage in purposeful work, learning becomes unforgettable.

In the first stage of the course, students are invited to observe and care for a single tree in their community: to name it; study it; draw it; and document its life. In doing so, they begin to understand trees not just as part of the landscape but as living companions and intelligent contributors to the planet's survival.

Once they've built that relationship, students hold a vote to decide where they want their forest to grow. With over 30

Ryan Schools, Evergreen and Upschool Join Forces to Plant a Forest 7 Times the Size of Central Park.

evergreen

WOW!

I'm grateful to be a part of the vision that empowers our students to serve the planet, enabling them to learn for life!

Ryan Schools is home to over 250,000 children

upschool

Scan here to get involved

Dr Snehal Pinto **Gavin McCormack**

countries to choose from (including Mozambique, Nepal, the Philippines, Canada, Madagascar, and Brazil) their decision becomes a global connection. Evergreen then plants the forest on the school's behalf and sends back a custom video of the planting.

One child put it best when they exclaimed, "I can't believe we planted a forest in another country!"

THE MOVEMENT BEGINS

Among the first to join this initiative was Ryan International Schools, one of India's leading educational networks. Under the guidance of Dr. Snehal Pinto, Ryan Schools committed to using the course not only to educate, but to mobilize their students into one of the most impactful forest-planting campaigns ever initiated by a school network.

"I'm grateful to be a part of the vision that empowers our students to serve the planet, enabling them to learn for life." – Dr. Pinto

Delhi International School, Dwarka, led by Anubha Srivastava and Muskaan Mehta, quickly followed. Their students have already begun creating a legacy: writing reflections; designing artwork; and taking part in forest planning across continents.

These schools aren't alone. From Costa Rica to Rwanda, teachers and students are proving that meaningful action can start with a lesson and end with a living, breathing forest.

As McCormack explains, "When a child plants a tree for someone they'll never meet, they learn that kindness doesn't need applause. That's where true education begins."

WHERE WILL YOU PLANT YOURS?

Thanks to the partnership with Evergreen, every school enrolled in the course can vote on where they'd like to plant their forest. The course invites schools to choose locations where reforestation is needed most, allowing them to discuss global challenges while making a tangible difference.

The map serves as both a lesson and a symbol, reminding students that education has the power to extend far beyond the classroom walls, across oceans and into communities they may never visit, but will have touched forever.

A CURRICULUM THAT LASTS A LIFETIME

What sets this course apart is not just its message, but its method. Designed to be cross-curricular, it weaves through science, literacy, geography, environmental studies, and the arts. Children write stories and poems, analyze environmental challenges, and explore how ecosystems work together in harmony.

Backed by research into how purpose-driven learning impacts long-term memory and emotional development, the course also taps into neuroscience. When children take meaningful action, their brains form stronger, more lasting connections, making this both a cognitive and emotional journey.

A MISSION ROOTED IN BELIEF

At the heart of this movement is a single, unwavering belief: Every child deserves to feel their true potential to change the world.

Gavin McCormack and the team at Upschool created *The Wonderful World of Trees* not just to teach children about deforestation or environmental science, but to help them become connected, compassionate, and courageous. The result? A course that doesn't just inform — it transforms.

JOIN THE GLOBAL MOVEMENT

This is not a call for passive learning. It's a call for schools to take part in something living, breathing, and urgent.

The course is completely free. It comes with a six-week lesson plan, video content, creative assignments, and a direct link to global forest planting. It's ready to use, right now.

Because when children believe they can change the world — they usually do. ■

Reach out to Gavin directly at: gavin@upschool.co

Access the course online at: courses.upschool.co/short-course/the-wonderful-world-of-trees

Or scan the QR code to get started.



Gavin McCormack is a Montessori teacher, former Montessori school principal, and the co-founder of Upschool.co, a global platform providing free educational courses for children and high-quality training for teachers. With ten years of Montessori teaching experience and 25 years in total, Gavin is committed to fostering lifelong skills through purposeful, real-world learning.

Gavin has travelled the world to bring the best the planet has to offer to children everywhere. His educational expeditions have taken him to some of the most remarkable locations on Earth, including Mount Everest, Antarctica, Costa Rica, the Arctic Circle, Iceland, the Chitwan Jungle, and soon Greenland. In each of these places, along with the team at Upschool, he has filmed educational content, collaborated with local communities, and developed courses that connect children with the wonders of the natural world and the lessons it holds.

He has received multiple accolades, including a nomination for Australian of the Year and a 'Best Contribution to Education' award at the GESS Dubai Awards. He is an author of children's books and a practical guide on Montessori education for parents. His TEDx talk and presentations at global conferences focus on the importance of hands-on, meaningful learning experiences.

New to Montessori

by Cathie Perolman

DEAR CATHIE—

WE ARE NEW TO THE MONTESSORI PHILOSOPHY AND WANT TO MAKE THE MOST OF IT IN OUR FAMILY AND OUR CHILDREN'S LIVES. WE HAVE COME TO THIS A BIT LATE, AS WE JUST MOVED TO AN AREA WITH A MONTESSORI SCHOOL. WE HAVE ENROLLED BOTH OF OUR CHILDREN AND ARE TRYING TO LEARN AS QUICKLY AS POSSIBLE. WHAT ARE THE KINDS OF THINGS WE SHOULD BE DOING AT HOME TO SUPPORT THE TYPE OF LEARNING THE CHILDREN ARE DOING AT SCHOOL?

—JUST BEGINNING...

Dear Parents,

You are asking all the right questions and doing all the right things! Montessori is indeed a philosophy, and you can't adopt it too late in the life of your family or your child's life. In a Montessori school, the guides believe that your child will reveal himself through the work that he chooses and shows us- the adults in his life- that which he needs to learn at that time.

It is our job to aid him in this journey, showing him skills and activities that interest him, challenge him, and grow his academic, social, and motoric skills as he moves along this path. We strive to allow him as much freedom as he can handle in doing things for himself and being independent. We create an environment with maximum accessibility based on the ages and skills of the children and then teach them to use the materials in that environment safely. An Infant/Toddler environment would let children be able to reach their own diapers and their own lunch box, so they can show us when they are hungry. A 3-6-year-old environment might contain scissors, a stapler, a



tape dispenser, sewing needles, etc. An Elementary environment is much richer with all the tools and resources a child would need to plan a complicated individual or group project or a "going out" field trip of their choosing and planning, such as phones and internet accessibility.

The primary ways that your family can help are to allow your child to be as independent as possible in all areas of his life. Let your child do as much for himself as his age and skill set allow in the areas of dressing, eating, food preparation, and contributing to his family. Let him choose his clothing and dress himself as much as he is able. If he cannot do

all of a dressing task, let him do the part that he can. If he is not strong enough to pull on his whole sock, you can pull the sock over his heel and he can pull it up to his ankle. If he cannot manage his shirt, let him place his hands in the sleeve holes and then help him get his head into the head hole. Together, pull the shirt over his torso. Removing clothes is an easier skill and will be mastered more quickly. With that comes the responsibility of placing the dirty clothes into the dirty clothes hamper. Sure, you can do it quicker, but letting him do it aids him in the path to independence! As he gets older, invite him to help you sort the laundry, match the clean socks, fold the dish

towels, and carry his own lunch box to the car and into school. Try to constantly think of things that you are doing that your child might be able to do for himself.

Strive for independence in eating and food preparation. At meal time, encourage your child to help prepare the meal. Teach your child to set the table. Perhaps at first, he will only place the napkins under the fork. But eventually, he will know where all the parts of the table setting go and will be able to do it independently. This is a great way to get some quality family time while teaching valuable table setting and food preparation skills. A child as young as two can tear lettuce, and a three or four can cut vegetables using a child-friendly knife (www.for-small-hands.com/small-nylon-knife). Preschoolers can also help to cut vegetables or fruit, even when they are not brave enough to eat them. Once the meal is on the table, encourage your child to serve himself from the family serving bowls. This is good practice in motor control as well as choosing the amount of food you are planning to eat. If your child is elementary-aged and your family is ordering “take out,” allow your child to help in the planning and even in making the phone call to order the food.

Allow your child to get his own snacks independently within reason. Create a place in your home that has snacks available for your child. Let him choose his own snack food from among those choices. Since you—as the parent—stock the snack spot, you still have ultimate control over how much and what your child is eating. But your child is gaining valuable

practice in making choices about what to eat and how often to eat from these limited choices. If your refrigerator allows it, place a small pitcher and glass on a low shelf so your child can pour his own water or juice when he is thirsty.



As he moves towards Kindergarten, he is probably ready to take over parts of packing his own school lunch. Try to arrange your refrigerator so that the things that your child will need for his lunch are available for him to access independently. He can select his own yogurt, or make his own sandwich, put his own fruit into the reusable container (and close it), and fill his own water bottle. Let it be a joint effort until his skills are solid, and then let that be your child’s work, and he has mastered another piece of independence. Let your child be a part of choosing what food to buy each week so he gets experience being a smart consumer, buying appropriate types and quantities of food at the grocery store. Once he is old enough, he will be able to contribute to the family grocery list and eventually shop for himself with confidence and skill.

Encourage your child to contribute to the family as well. A very young child can do simple tasks such as taking their plate to the sink, hanging up their towel, or putting their toys away. Children a bit older

can bring in the mail, feed the dog, empty the trash cans in the house, or take out the garbage. Families can work together to plan vacations, solve problems within their family, or create a potential new project, such as a vegetable garden or a fire pit. All of these things help the family to function as a unit and to help children realize that they are members of a group.

Optimal development is the goal of every Montessori classroom and every family. Guides encourage each child to grow in their social, emotional, academic, self-help, and motor skills, each on their timetable. All the adults in a child’s life help him along his path to independence, and by working together, parents and Montessori schools aid the optimal development of a child so he can become his most authentic, happy, and healthy self. ■



Cathie Perolman has been involved in Montessori education for over 40 years. Cathie has worked in the classroom as a 3-6 assistant; a classroom teacher; a level leader; a teacher trainer; and a college professor. She currently spends her time mentoring teachers, conducting workshops for teachers and administrators; and writing for her blog and for magazines. She also serves as a consultant for schools and as a school validator for the Montessori Schools of Maryland. Cathie is the creator of the **Color Coded Sound Games** and the **Rainbow Reading System** as well as other reading and cosmic printable materials to enhance classrooms. Find them at cathieperolman.com.

Books to Inspire

0–3 years



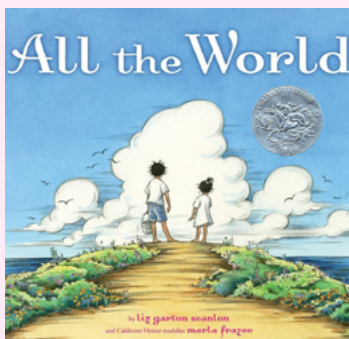
Global Babies

by Global Fund for Children

A sturdy, multicultural board book featuring photographs of babies worldwide. Reflects real-world diversity and fosters early connection.



Global Babies available here, on Amazon



All the World

by Liz Garton Scanlon & Marla Frazee

A lyrical celebration of connection, nature, and family, encouraging mindfulness and calm.



All the World available here, on Amazon.

3–6 years



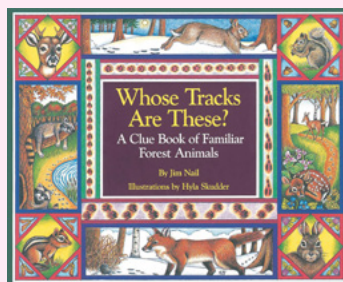
The Story of the Root Children

by Sibylle von Olfers

A seasonal tale celebrating nature's rhythm, perfect for autumn and sensory exploration.



The Story of the Root Children available here, on Amazon.



Whose Tracks Are These?

by Jim Nail

A nature-based clue book that engages observation and reasoning—ideal for curious nature-lovers.



Whose Tracks Are These? available here, on Amazon.

6–9 years



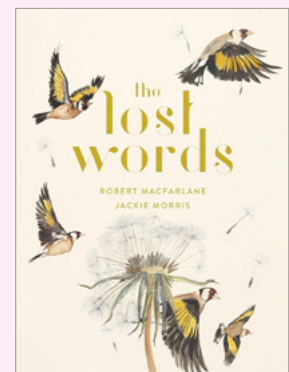
The Secrets of the Apple Tree: A Shine-a-Light Book

by Carron Brown & Alyssa Nassner

An interactive nonfiction exploration of nature's hidden wonders—ideal for fall curiosity.



The Secrets of the Apple Tree available here, on Amazon.



The Lost Words

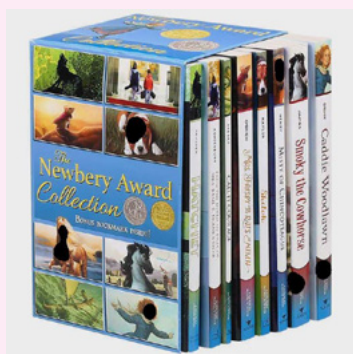
by Robert Macfarlane & Jackie Morris

A lyrical celebration of nature vocabulary, blending poetry and painting to reclaim words fading from children's lexicon.



The Lost Words available here, on Amazon.

9–12 years



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